

LEGALIZED EVIL

During my sophomore year of college, in 2007, I moved out of the dorms and into a shared house in Boston's Allston neighborhood. The duplex I lived in with my two roommates rented for \$1,500 total (which is typically the rent cost for one person where I live now in LA. Ugh.) My portion was \$500. We had very little furniture, and the floors were always sticky for no discernible reason.

Like in high school, I saved no money at all in college, but I don't remember spending that much money either. My loans and my scholarship were covering my tuition, and the biggest expenses were textbooks and beer. (That might explain the sticky floors, actually.) Everything my group of friends did was very cheap, and we prided ourselves on that. I had a job almost the whole time I was in college, working as a paid intern for the *Boston Globe* where I made \$1,000 a month, half of which went toward my rent. I got the gig at the *Globe* through my unpaid work at Emerson's college newspaper, the *Berkeley Beacon*. I don't remember a time during my freshman year that I wasn't either in class or working in the *Beacon*'s basement offices. I was determined to climb up the ranks and eventually become editor-in-chief my senior year. If it interfered with the *Beacon*—study-abroad opportunities, relationships, hobbies, homework—it was gone.

When it came time to apply for the job at the *Globe*, we *Beacon* staffers had to compete not only with each other, but also with newspaper staffs from schools all around Boston, at places like Northeastern, Suffolk, and Harvard. There were four shifts on the news desk. In my interview with the *Globe* editors, hoping no one would want it and it would allow me to more easily land the position, I said it was my dream to have the late-night crime reporting slot (6:00 p.m.–2:00 a.m.).

I got it.